

Master the Calendar, Centering, Macros and Drawing Tools in GNU Emacs



Here's another great article in the GNU Emacs series, which tutors readers on using the inbuilt calendar and then leads them through the text and drawing tools.

In this article in our ongoing series on GNU Emacs, you will learn how to use its calendar, center text, macros and drawing tools.

Calendar

You can use and display a calendar inside GNU Emacs using the following command (see Figure 1):

`M-x calendar`



Figure 1: Calendar

Day

You can move forward by a day using the 'C-f' shortcut, and move back a day using the 'C-b' keys. You can move to the current date using the '.' key.

To start the week on a Monday, set the following command in your `~/.emacs`.

```
(setq calendar-week-start-day 1)
```

Week

If you wish to move forward by a week, you can use the 'C-n' shortcut, and to move back by a week, use the 'C-p' shortcut. The 'C-a' shortcut can be used to move to the beginning of the week, while the 'C-e' shortcut can be used to move to the end of the week.

Month

You can move to the beginning of a month using the 'M-a' shortcut. To move to the end of the month, use 'M-e'.

You can move forward and backward a month using the 'M-)' and 'M-{ ' shortcuts, respectively.

If you wish to scroll forward three months, use the 'C-v' shortcut. To scroll backward three months, use the 'M-v' shortcut.

Year

In order to move forward a year, you can use the 'C-x]' shortcut, and to move back a year, you can use the 'C-x[' shortcut.

You can go to a specified date using the 'g d' key combination. It will then prompt you with the messages: "Year (>0):", "Month name:" and "Day (1-31):", and will take you to the specified date.

You can move to the beginning of the year using the 'M-<' shortcut, and to the end of the year using the 'M-v' shortcut.

You are encouraged to read the 'Calendar' section in